100 DAYS OF PRACTICAL AI

Is this message a scam? 5 quick checks

By Rahul · @imsikarwar.rahul · before you tap any link

1. **Pressure:** “expires today”, “account will be blocked”. Real banks rarely threaten by SMS.
2. **Link:** short links or look-alike names (not the bank’s real address) are a warning. Do not click suspicious or unverified links; type the official address or use the official app.
3. **Asks for secrets:** OTP, PIN, password, card number. Never share them with anyone, and never read an OTP out to a caller or agent, even one who says they are from the bank.
4. **Small unexpected fee:** “pay ₹29 for redelivery” is a classic. Check parcels in the courier’s own app.
5. **You did not start it:** an OTP text is normal only if *you* started that payment. If not, call your bank on its official number.

What to do instead

- Open the official app yourself or call your bank on its official number.
- Ask a family member if unsure. Report to your bank. Delete the message.

Using AI as a second opinion

> Here are three messages I received: [paste]. For each, say if it looks like a scam, list the red flags, and what I should do. Say how sure you are and what you cannot check.

I tested this on six made-up messages (Claude, 3 Nov 2026): two genuine, four scams, including an OTP trick and a look-alike bank link. It got all six right and flagged nothing genuine as a scam. They were still examples I wrote myself. AI cannot open links or see who really sent a message, so it can be wrong. Verify in the official app.